

► **Problem:** Some movie DVDs don't play on your DVD drive

Cause: The movie is region locked, and will only play on a DVD drive that has the same region code. To control the release of their movies, the motion picture group divided the world into seven regions or zones. Each zone has its own region or zone number. When a specific movie is released in a particular zone, it is encoded with the zone number. DVD players, too, have a zone number. Hence, a movie released in America plays on all DVD players manufactured in the US, but not on DVD players manufactured in India such as those from Onida, Mitashi, Sony, etc.

Solution: Many DVD players can be hacked using software to do away with the region locking encryption. This voids the warranty, but it isn't illegal to do so. On some drives, however, you need to modify the chip to make it all-region playable.

7.3 External Storage Devices

► **Problem:** Windows pops up a message saying, "A HI-SPEED USB device plugged into a non-HI-SPEED USB hub."

Cause: This problem generally occurs when one plugs a USB 2.0 device into a USB port, the reason being the lack of proper drivers.

Solution: In you're using Windows XP, make sure you have installed the drivers for proper functioning of the USB 2.0 hub. Most motherboards rely on Microsoft-certified USB drivers for USB 2.0. You can download the USB 2.0 drivers from Microsoft's Web site, or you can install Windows XP SP2.

► **Problem:** Your Flash drive is 512 MB, but it can't store data more than 256 MB

Cause: This is a common problem with most cheap Flash drives. Though they are advertised as 512 MB and show up as 512 MB in the system, they have a bad memory chip that doesn't allow copying of data more than 256 MB.

Solution: Don't take chances with Flash memory. Buy a Flash drive only from a reliable and known manufacturer.